

Systems Analysis Document

Jane Dias | BUS 395: Venture Creation with AI | June 2, 2026

1. Sharpened Problem Statement

Every day, women shop both in stores and online, but without a clear understanding of their personal body type, measurements, or sense of style, and many end up making purchases they regret later. Some women may hire a personal stylist, or can afford to spend thousands of dollars curating their wardrobe, or may just have a keen eye for developing their sense of style. But, for women who have a limited budget, less time, or struggle to dress for their body type, the result is a cycle of buying clothes, returning them, and being left with the feeling of having no idea what to wear, and a lack of confidence in what they do have in their wardrobe.

2. 5 Whys Analysis

Starting point: Women lack confidence and knowledge about their personal body type and style.

Why 1: *Why do women frequently purchase clothing they later do not like or wear?*

Marketing and sales can influence shoppers to make purchases through emotional triggers, companies create scarcity and urgency for customers, and shopping environments as well as physical stores are designed in ways to make you look better in mirrors or feel more confident, while websites use color psychology and experience design to create satisfying shopping experiences (Sanders, 2024). This results in women purchasing clothing that does not ultimately fit their preferences, bodytype, or lifestyle as they expected after purchasing.

Why 2: *Why does the clothing not fit women's lifestyle, preferences, or appearance as expected?*

Many women struggle to determine which clothing styles, cuts, or colors best suit them before they make a purchase. Recently, Vogue Business found through their surveys that sizing and a

misrepresentation of body types, accompanied by pressure to lose weight in order to feel fashionable, is stopping consumers from shopping (Maguire & Shoaib, 2025).

Why 3: *Why do many women struggle to understand which clothing styles and silhouettes suit them?*

Generic sizing charts are more accessible, however less consistent, and require less research and time than individualized guidance such as The Kibee Body Type Test. Additionally, some women may rely on social media influencers who they feel they share similar body types to or the advice of friends.

Why 4: *Why is personal styling guidance inconsistent or inaccessible?*

Retailers' main goal is to sell products, rather than help shoppers curate their personal style and understand their unique qualities. Additionally, personal stylists can cost anywhere between \$50-\$500+ an hour, and even "complimentary styling" services offered at malls or department stores often require a minimum spend of \$1000 or more.

Why 5: *Why is it difficult for women to determine which clothing will suit them?*

Outside of generic sizing charts, there is a lack of systems or tools that simply translates a person's preferences, body type, and goals into individualized clothing recommendations or honest/unbiased advice.

Root Cause: Women lack affordable and accessible tools that help them understand their body type, goals, and personal style before purchasing clothing.

3. Customer Segment and Discovery Prep

Primary Segment: Women seeking to build their wardrobe and develop their personal style that aligns with their body type and budget. Acquiring a personal stylist, or spending thousands of dollars a year on clothing does not align with their budget and personal goals. Even if your wardrobe is full of clothes, bodies change, as well as trends, so many women are looking to maintain a wardrobe that helps them feel confident.

Secondary Segment: Women shopping for specific occasions, who may not need constant shopping or fashion guidance, but want to ensure they are dressed appropriately for the event. This can be for occasions such as weddings, vacations, job interviews, a first date, a new job, etc.

Describing my first 10 interview targets:

- 2 women with a limited budget for clothing, but would like to expand their wardrobe (I have already spoken to them about an interview, they are Aly and Mya)
- 3 women who have expressed to me that they feel they have unique body types and struggle to find clothing that looks good on them (I already know who I will ask, Zoe, Miko and Allison)
- 1 woman who is a new mom and has limited time alone to go shopping (I already know who I will ask)
- 1 middle aged woman who is actively working on weight loss and loves shopping, but with a limited budget (Anne)
- 1 women who worked in fashion who may have seen customers experience this first hand (her name is Meg)
- 1 women who is very good with money, and does not like to spend a lot of money on clothes (I know who I will ask, Danai)

- 1 women who recently lost a considerable amount of weight (I already know who I will ask, Zarina)

How I plan to reach them: I will be contacting them in person or over the phone since I already know them.

Draft Interview Questions:

1. Walk me through the last time you went shopping for clothing alone, did you try things on, did you feel satisfied with your purchase, did you return anything, how did you decide what to buy?
2. Tell me about the last time you bought clothing that you ended up not wearing or rarely wearing, what happened?
3. When you shop for clothing, what factors do you consider before making a purchase?
4. Have there been any changes in your lifestyle, body, or personal style that have affected the way you dress or the way you shop? Tell me about your experience.
5. What do you typically do when you are unsure whether or not a piece of clothing will look good on you?

Who NOT to Interview

- **Retail Executives/Clothing brand owners:** These people most likely profit from this problem, and would prefer that there is no solution.
- **Professional stylists/Fashion influencers:** Most likely, these individuals have a deep understanding of their own body type, larger budget for clothing, and a greater understanding of what silhouettes will highlight their features

4. Early Competitive Scan

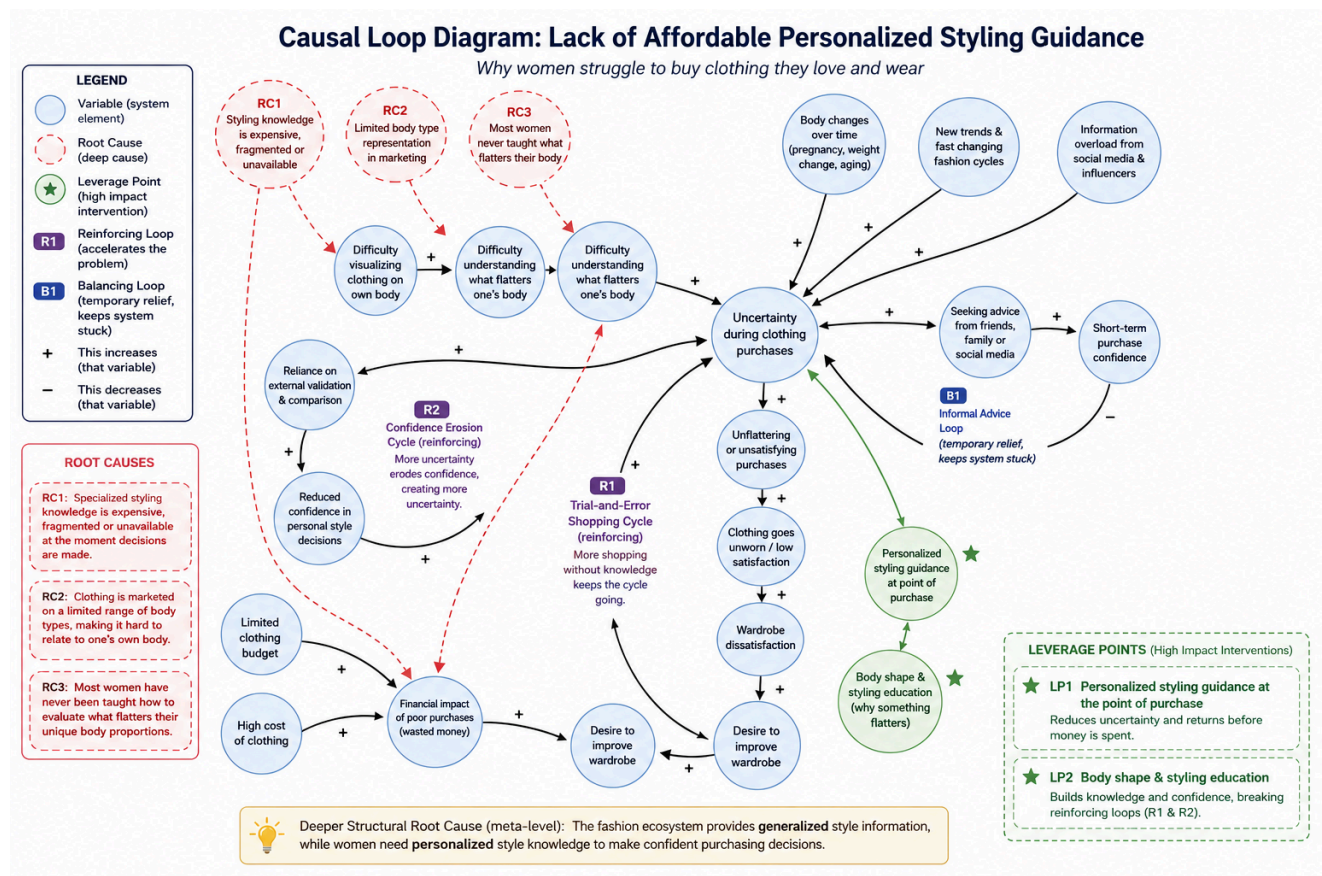
Category	Who	Notes
Direct	Style DNA	AI Wardrobe stylist that helps you discover your color palette, pick out outfits from your own wardrobe and online shopping assistance. Reviews mostly point towards the color analysis element, and don't mention anything about body type or feedback based on something you tried on.
Direct	Stitch Fix	Personalized clothing recommendations based on style profiles. A stylist will pick the clothing for you and you can mail back what you don't want. Reviews suggest that the app is for those who do not want to deal with picking out clothing themselves.
Indirect	Nuuly	Clothing rental service that allows you to pick 6 pieces of clothing a month. Eliminates the need for regretting clothing purchases, and spending a lot of money on clothes. However, if the clothing you pick online does not fit right or look good on you, it is still a waste of money.
Indirect	Fashion Blogs or body-type guides	Provides a lot of information, but still requires extensive research and understanding to correctly identify your own body type and develop your personal style.
Workaround	Trial and error	Going shopping and returning items still takes time and money. You may also still be heavily influenced by in-store or online marketing.
Workaround	Ignore the problem and keep buying clothing you are unsure of	Spending thousands of dollars a year on clothes and shoes, just for many pieces to sit in your wardrobe untouched.

Key Gap: Other than body-type guides, existing solutions focus more on providing inspiration, can require a lot of independent research, or focus on selling clothing, rather

than helping women understand their unique body shape, personal style, budget, and personal needs

5. AI-Generated Systems Map

The map was generated using ChatGpt



Stakeholders: Women shoppers ages 22-60 years old (target group), personal stylists, retailers, fashion influencers, friends/family providing advice

Reinforcing loop (R1): Trial-and-Error Shopping Cycle- more shopping without knowledge keeps the cycle going

Reinforcing loop (R2): Confidence Erosion Cycle- more uncertainty erodes confidence, creating more uncertainty.

Balancing loop (B1): “Informal Advice Loop- leading to temporary relief” which keeps shoppers stuck in the system, uncertainty during purchases leads to seeking advice from friends, family or social media, which causes short-term purchases confidence

Root cause (structural): Fashion industry provides generalized information, and models share similar slim body types, while women need personalized style advice and knowledge to make confident purchasing decisions.

Leverage points: (1) Personalized styling guidance at the point of purchase- reduces uncertainty and returns before money is spent (2) Body shape & styling education which builds knowledge and confidence, which breaks reinforcing loops R1 and R2.

6. AI Conversation Log

Tool Used: ChatGpt

<https://chatgpt.com/share/6a1f382f-4e38-83ea-b105-8d8a8bdc46f9>

Sources:

<https://medium.com/@doctorofshopping/the-psychology-of-shopping-a-deep-dive-into-why-we-really-buy-089c02370d8f>

<https://www.vogue.com/article/sizing-is-stopping-consumers-from-shopping-heres-what-brands-need-to-know>

<https://socialgarb.com/blogs/tips/how-much-does-a-personal-stylist-cost>